

Windows PC vs Mac

The two most popular types of computer are PCs and Macs. PCs usually run on the Microsoft Windows operating system (OS). They are the most widely used type of computer, particularly in businesses, and there is a wide range of software available for them. However, PCs are more prone to viruses and malware because of their popularity and the design of the OS. Macs – made by Apple Inc. – are less widely used, but are particularly popular with graphic designers and photographers. They tend to be more expensive, but are less vulnerable to viruses.

▷ Which to choose?

This depends on a variety of factors: price, what system the user is most comfortable with, whether or not the software they need is available for their choice, and how the computer will be used.

The **choice of desktop or laptop, PC or Mac** is a **personal one**.

	Pros	Cons
Windows PC	Usually cheaper	More susceptible to viruses
	More software available	Frequent OS updates
	More hardware available	Tend not to last as long
Mac	Better quality and design	More expensive
	Smooth user experience	Less hardware available
	Lower risk of viruses	Slightly smaller choice of software

Weighing up the factors

Before choosing a new computer it's worth thinking carefully about various factors. These include what it will be used for, whether portability or space is important, what the available budget is, and whether there are ergonomic issues that need to be considered. When it comes to the choice between a PC or Mac a great deal depends on the user's familiarity with either of these types of computer. Asking family or friends for their recommendations is a good way to get help in making a decision.

▽ Right for the job

The choice of desktop or laptop, and PC or Mac, is a personal one. Numerous factors can influence a decision, but there is no perfect computer, just computers that are right for the tasks for which they are needed.

